coursera | MoMA

Seeing Through Photographs

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

- Welcome to Seeing Through Photographs! Reading • 3 min
- Getting Started: How Does This Course Work? Reading • 6 min
- Seeing Through Photographs Course Trailer Video • 1 min
- Sarah Meister Introduces the Course Video • 2 min
- Marvin Heiferman on "Photography Changes Everything" Video • 3 min
- Optional Discussion Forum Prompts Reading • 10 min
- Optional Readings and Resources Reading • 10 min

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Part I: Introduction

- Introduction to Module 1 Reading • 2 min
- Artistic Equivalents Reading • 2 min
- Vik Muniz on Photographing the Familiar Video • 3 min

Part II: Telescopes and Cameras

- Introduction to Part II: Surface, Scale, and Technology Video • 2 min
- Practical Scenario Real-world application • 5 min
- Moons and Surfaces Reading • 6 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Eugène Atget. Pendant l'éclipse. 1912 Video • 3 min
- Hear More: Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009 Video • 1 min
- Surface, Scale, Technology Dialogue • 15 min

Part III: Seeing the Unseen

- Introduction to Part III: Man on the Moon Video • 2 min
- Photographs by NASA Reading • 2 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on U.S.G.S. and NASA, Surveyor III. Surface of the Moon, Day 319, III-F. 1967 Video • 1 min
- Practical Scenario Real-world application • 5 min
- Who Does the Moon Belong To? Reading • 4 min

Part IV: It's Only a Paper Moon

- Introduction to Part IV: Vernacular and Fine Art Photographs of the Moon Video • 3 min
- Moon Phases Reading • 6 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Ansel Adams. Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico. 1941 Video • 3 min
- Man on the Moon and Paper Moons Dialogue • 15 min

Part V: Review and Respond

- **Optional Readings and Resources** Reading • 10 min
- Practice Memory Check Practice Assignment • 30 min
- Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Module 4
One and Another

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Optional Readings and Resources

0:06 / 2:16 1x

Below are **optional** readings and resources that provide additional content for the concepts and artworks featured in the course. Please note that these are **NOT required**; you can complete the course without reviewing them. You are also welcome to explore them after you complete the course.

Please consider supporting the Museum's mission by purchasing your favorite books at the MoMA Store. For your convenience, all MoMA publications featured in the course are gathered in the course bibliography and on the MoMA Store website.

Selected Excerpts of MoMA Publications

Kynaston McShine. "Vik Muniz." In *Museum as Muse: Artists Reflect*. The Museum of Modern Art, 1999,134–135. Access the full catalogue here.

Sarah Meister. "Not Necessarily Art: Nineteenth-Century American Photographs." In *Photography at MoMA: 1840 to 1920*. The Museum of Modern Art, 2017, 188–191. Purchase the full publication at the MoMA Store.

John Szarkowski. "George Eastman and Alfred Stieglitz." In *Photography Until Now*. The Museum of Modern Art, 1990, 124-175.

John Szarkowski. *Alfred Stieglitz at Lake George*. The Museum of Modern Art, 1995, 8–32.

Additional online content

Read: Articles about Photography published to MoMA Magazine

Watch: Seeing Through Photographs playlist on MoMA's YouTube channel

Watch: Ansel Adams's moon in *Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico*, SFMOMA.

Watch: The suspense of Ansel Adams's famous moonrise, SFMOMA.

Read: Allison Meier. "11,000 Photos of the Apollo Lunar Missions Land on Flickr." *Hyperallergic*, October 7, 2015.

Read: Sarah Hermanson Meister. "Eugène Atget's *Pendant l'Eclipse*." *OSMOS Magazine*, Fall 2013. 34-39.

Read: Sarah Cascone. "'It's an Absolute Monster': See How Astronomers Managed to Snap the First-Ever Photograph of a Black Hole." *Artnet*, April 10, 2019.

Artists in Module 2 on moma.org

Ansel Adams

Eugène Atget

Leandro Katz

Suirei Kubota

Maurice Loewy

Pierre Henri Puiseux

Cristina de Middel

Aleksandra Mir

Vik Muniz

NASA

Edward Steichen

Alfred Stieglitz

John Adams Whipple

Liz Deschenes

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